SECTION 26 PRESERVATION AND PROTECTION OF EXISTING TREES

Section 26 of the General Specification for Civil Engineering Works is replaced by the following Particular Specification.

TREE PRESERVATION AND PROTECTION OF EXISTING TREES

Definitions 26.01

(1) "Tree" means a plant with diameter at breast height measuring 95 mm or more. Plants growing on retaining structures shall also be measured and considered.

(2) "Diameter at breast height" means the diameter of the trunk of the plant measured at a height of 1.3 m above ground level. For trunk with an obviously elliptical cross-section, the diameter at breast height shall be the average of any two diameter measurements taken at right-angle.

(3) "Tree crown spread" means the diameter of the tree crown defined by the outermost branches of the tree.

(4) "Tree height" means the height from ground level to the top of the tree.

(5) "Dripline" of a tree means the imaginary vertical plumb line that extends downward from the tips of the outermost tree branches and intersects the ground.

(6) "Tree protection zone" means an area the perimeter of which is defined by the dripline of the tree.

(7) "Preserved tree" means an existing tree not earmarked to be felled, which may be a tree to be retained at its existing location, a tree at its existing location prior to transplanting, or a tree transplanted within the Site.

(8) "Arboricultural work" means any work related to the cultivation and care of trees for any purpose other than timber production, including but not limiting to planting, replanting, transplanting, tree surgery work and control of pest and disease.

Specialist Contractor 26.02

If the *Contractor* is not included in the "List of Approved Suppliers of Materials and Specialist Contractors for Public Works" under the category of "Landscaping: Class I – General Landscape Work", he shall enter into a written sub-contract with a specialist contractor pursuant to Clause C3 of *additional conditional of contract* to carry out the arboricultural work to trees, including but not limited to planting, replanting, transplanting, tree surgery work, and control of pest and disease.

Programming 26.03

The *Contractor* shall fully allow the effects of preservation and protection of existing trees in his programme, the method of operation and construction, and the vehicular access for the *works*.

Preservation and protection of existing trees

26.04 (1) The *Contractor* shall assign a competent member with arboriculture knowledge of the site supervisory staff to oversee and supervise tree works related to arboricultural operations and preservation of trees onsite and any compensatory planting both onsite and offsite, including, but without limitation to, planting, transplanting, arboriculture work and control of pests and diseases affecting trees on the Site. The person assigned shall be working part-time onsite but not necessarily working solely on tree works. The assigned person shall have attended relevant training in arboriculture organised by local/overseas training institutes (e.g. Construction Industry Council Training Academy, Vocational Training Council) with cumulative training of at least 30 hours in the past 3 years, and have at least two years practical experience in arboriculture. The *Contractor* shall submit to the *Supervisor* for approval within 30 days of the date of the *Client*'s letter of acceptance of the Tender particulars of the assigned person (including his name, experience and position) together with a copy of the certificate(s) issued by the training institute(s) confirming "his/her satisfactory completion of the relevant courses" and supporting documents on the required experience.

(2) The *Contractor* shall carry out a tree survey and submit the survey record to the *Supervisor* within 28 days of the date for *starting date*.

(3) The tree survey record shall cover all existing trees present within the Site or within 5m of the site boundary and any other trees likely to be affected by the *works*. The tree survey record shall be in the form of an A4-sized, bound report which shall bear a report cover indicating the Contract number, Contract title, and date of the report and shall include the following documents, the formats of which shall be agreed by the *Supervisor* prior to submission of the report:

(a) a tree survey plan showing the locations of all existing trees.

(b) a tree schedule comprising the following information:

(i) botanical name of the tree species and the identity code/number as shown on the tree survey plan,

(ii) diameter at breast height of the tree,

(iii) tree crown spread,

(iv) tree height,

(v) condition of the tree including its form and health (highlighting any structural defects or unhealthy or decaying symptoms which may pose danger to the public if the tree falls), amenity value, survival rate after transplanting

and special features, and

(vi) existing ground level at the trunk base, and

(c) photographic record for each *individual tree/tree group/individual tree and tree group complying with the following:

(i) all photographs shall be date-stamped to indicate the dates that the photographs are taken and shall be well-annotated, and

(ii) the photograph of each tree shall show clearly the whole tree as far as possible, the identification number of the tree, and the status of the tree as identified by the labelling or marking system on the Site as required in sub-clause (4) of this Clause,

(4) The *Contractor* shall mark on the Site with labelling or marking systems. The *Contractor* shall comply with the following in providing the identification labelling or marking systems:

(a) the identification labelling or marking systems for different tree status shall be in different colours and be clearly distinguishable,

(b) the identification labelling or marking system for the preserved trees shall be made of durable materials that are non-injurious to the trees, be placed at a position not easily accessible to the public, and be attached in such a manner that allows for the growth of the trees and does not injure the trees,

(c) the identification labelling or marking systems and the on-site status identification of trees shall be agreed by the *Supervisor* and installed prior to the commencement of site clearance, demolition, construction of permanent or temporary works, and any other site operations which may affect the trees, and

(d) the *Contractor* shall reinstate or replace where necessary the identification labelling or marking systems for the preserved trees and shall remove these identification labelling or marking systems from the Site upon completion of the relevant *section* of the *works*, or earlier if so directed by the *Supervisor*.

(5) The limits of site clearance shall be agreed by the *Supervisor* on the Site before site clearance commences.

(6) All existing trees within the Site are to be preserved. The *Contractor* is not allowed to fell or transplant any existing trees unless otherwise agreed by the *Supervisor.* For the preserved trees, the *Contractor* shall exercise the greatest care

to avoid any damage to them and shall comply with the following:

(a) take all necessary precautions to ensure that:

(i) no nails or other fixings shall be driven into the trees, including the exposed tree roots,

(ii) no fencing, services, or signs other than the identification labels or markings required under sub-clause (4) of this Clause shall be attached to any part of the trees,

(iii) no trees shall be used as anchorages for ropes or chains used in guying or pulling or for equipment used for removing stumps, roots or other trees, or for any other purposes,

(iv) no soil, materials, equipment or machinery shall be stockpiled or stored within the tree protection zones,

(v) no site offices, workshops, canteens, containers or similar structures shall be installed within the tree protection zones,

(vi) petrol, oil, bitumen, creosote, cement and other materials likely to be injurious to the trees shall be kept away from the tree protection zones, and any accidental spills of these materials shall be cleaned up immediately,

(vii) excessive water shall be drained away from the tree protection zones to prevent damage to tree roots by asphyxiation,

(viii) the surface on slopes shall be shaped so that water will not drain to the tree trunks but bypass them,

(ix) no passage or parking of vehicles and no operation of equipment or machinery shall take place within the tree protection zones unless otherwise agreed by the *Supervisor*,

(x) no stripping of surface vegetation or top layer of soil shall be carried out within the tree protection zones unless otherwise agreed by the *Supervisor*,

(xi) no fires shall be lit within the tree protection zones or in a position where the flames will likely extend to within 5 m of foliage, branches or trunks of the trees, bearing in mind the size of the fire and the wind direction,

(xii) no concrete mixing, gas tank filling, paintbrush and tool cleaning, or equipment maintenance shall be carried out within the tree protection zones,

(xiii) any necessary scarification or cultivation within the tree protection zones shall be carried out carefully by hand so as not to cause damage to the trees, in particular the bark and the roots,

(xiv) any equipment, in particular delivery vehicles, overhead cranes, mechanical excavations, drilling rigs and piling rigs, shall be carefully operated so as not to cause striking of the trunks, branches, foliage or root collars of the trees,

(xv) the trees to be felled that are adjacent to, or that lie within a continuous canopy of, the preserved trees, shall be carefully removed, and if necessary in sections but not using bulldozers in any circumstances, so as not to cause damage to the preserved trees such as scraping bark off trunks or breaking branches of trees,

(xvi) where it is necessary to use herbicides to kill any vegetation, herbicides that can leach through the soil, such as the products containing sodium chlorate, and any other herbicides that are injurious to the trees shall not be used,

(xvii) allowance shall be made for the slope of the ground so that damaging materials such as concrete washings, mortar or diesel oil cannot run towards the trees,

(xviii) alkaline clays or limestones shall not be used for filling or paving, concrete shall be mixed on a thick plastic tarpaulin or outside the Site, and mixing trucks shall not be rinsed out on the Site, so as not to cause changes, in particular increases, in soil pH, and

(xix) all building debris and chemical wastes shall be hauled away for proper disposal, and in any circumstances shall not be burned or buried on the Site or be disposed of by pouring them on the soil within the Site,

(b) repair any damage to the trees in accordance with the requirements stipulated in PS Clause 26.12,

(c) where the passage or parking of vehicles or the operation of equipment or machinery within the tree protection zones as referred to in sub-clause (6)(a)(ix) of this Clause is considered necessary and is agreed by the

Supervisor, carry out the following measures to reduce soil compaction:

(i) minimise the traffic of the vehicles, equipment or machinery, and

(ii) confine the passage or parking of vehicles or operation of equipment or machinery to the areas laid with temporary protective mulching as stipulated in PS Clause 26.05(6) and with double, overlapping, thick metal sheet coverings, or other materials of equivalent strength as agreed by the *Supervisor*, placed on top,

(d) Not used.

(e) protect the preserved trees, where necessary, from increased exposure to sun and wind due to removal of adjacent trees,

(f) Not used.

(g) report to the *Supervisor* of any preserved tree having structural defects or unhealthy or decaying symptoms which may pose danger to the public if the tree falls,

(h) update the photographic record taken in accordance with sub-clause (3)(c) of this Clause and submit a report on the updated photographic record to the *Supervisor* at bimonthly intervals or at intervals agreed by the *Supervisor*, complying with the following:

(i) each of the reports shall comprise all preserved trees,

(ii) each of the reports shall be in the form of an A4-sized, bound document which shall bear a report cover indicating the Contract number, Contract title, and date of the report,

(iii) the format of the reports shall be agreed by the *Supervisor* prior to submission of the first report,

(iv) all photographs shall be date-stamped to indicate the dates that the photographs are taken and shall be well-annotated,

(v) the photograph of each tree shall show clearly the whole tree as far as possible, the identification number of the tree, and the status of the tree as identified by the labelling or marking system on the Site as required in sub-clause (3) of this Clause, and

(vi) each of the reports shall include details of any damage caused to the trees and any signs of health deterioration of the trees in the reporting period, accompanied with photographic record of the damage and the tree deterioration.

(i) undertake tree risk assessment for the preserved trees in accordance with the "Guidelines for Tree Risk Assessment & Management Arrangement on an Area Basis and a Tree Basis" (the Guidelines) issued by Greening, Landscape and Tree Management Section of Development Bureau of the Government of HKSAR at bimonthly intervals or at intervals agreed by the *Supervisor*, as well as submit a Tree Risk Assessment Report to the *Supervisor* at bimonthly intervals or at intervals agreed by the *Supervisor*, until the Site is handed over back to the *Client*. The tree risk assessment shall include but not limiting to undertaking "Area Basis" and "Tree Basis" assessments in accordance with the Guidelines. The *Contractor* shall prepare Form 1 – Tree Group Inspection Form and Form 2 Tree Risk Assessment Form in accordance with the explanatory notes of Form 1 and Form 2 as stated in the Guidelines and incorporate them into the Tree Risk Assessment Report submitted to the *Supervisor*. Within 1 month after the *starting date*, the *Contractor* shall propose the "Inspection Officer" and the "Endorsement Officer" as required for undertake the tree risk assessment in accordance with the Guidelines to the *Supervisor* for approval. Requirements on training / qualification and experience of the "Inspection Officer" and the "Endorsement Officer" shall be in compliance with the Guidelines. The Guidelines, Form 1 – Tree Group Inspection Form, & Form 2 – Tree Risk Assessment Form to be used shall be the most updated version at the time the inspection and the assessment are carried out. The updated Guidelines and the Forms are available from the website of Greening, Landscape and Tree Management Section of Development Bureau or as given by the *Supervisor*.

Protection from physical damage and soil compaction by construction activities

26.05 (1) The *Contractor* shall erect, secure and maintain in good condition temporary protective fencing to protect the preserved trees. Details of the temporary protective fencing are shown in Drawing No. TP1 in PS Appendix Q whenever practicable. The *Contractor* shall submit method statements including construction details to the *Supervisor* for approval and obtain such approval before commencing the erection of the protective fencing.

(2) The temporary protective fencing shall be erected along or

beyond the perimeter of the tree protection zone of each individual tree. Where the tree protection zones of two or more trees overlap with each other, the temporary protective

fencing shall be erected along or beyond the perimeter of the aggregate tree protection zone of the trees or as directed by the *Supervisor*.

(3) The *Contractor* shall complete erection of the temporary protective fencing prior to the commencement of site clearance, demolition, construction of permanent or other temporary works, and any other site operations which may affect the trees.

(4) The *Contractor* shall remove the temporary protective fencing from the Site upon completion of the *section*, or earlier if so directed by the *Supervisor*. The *Contractor* shall not remove or relocate the temporary protective fencing or enter the area enclosed by the temporary protective fencing without the prior agreement of the *Supervisor*.

(5) The *Contractor* shall provide temporary protective hessian armouring around tree trunks to protect the preserved trees when erection of temporary protective fencing is not practicable or the preserved tree grows on a retaining structure. When instructed by the *Supervisor*, the *Contractor* shall provide temporary protective hessian and plank armouring as an alternative to the same trees for enhanced protection. Details of the temporary protective hessian armouring and hessian and plank armouring are shown in Drawing No. TP2 in PS Appendix Q.

(6) Unless otherwise agreed by the *Supervisor*, the ground of the tree protection zones of the trees referred to in the sub-clause (5) of this Clause shall be protected from damage by construction activities through the use of temporary protective mulching. When instructed by the *Supervisor*, double, overlapping, thick metal sheet coverings, or other materials of equivalent strength as agreed by the *Supervisor*, shall be laid on top of the temporary protective mulching to provide additional protection from soil compaction due to passage or parking of vehicles or operation of equipment or machinery. Details of the temporary protective mulching are shown in Drawing No. TP3 in PS Appendix Q.

(7) The *Contractor* shall complete erection of the temporary protective armouring and application of the temporary protective mulching prior to the commencement of site clearance, demolition, construction of permanent or other temporary works, and any other site operations which may affect the trees.

(8) The *Contractor* shall remove the temporary protective armouring and the temporary protective mulching from the Site upon completion of *section*, or earlier if so directed by the *Supervisor*. The *Contractor* shall not remove or relocate the temporary protective armouring or the temporary protective mulching without the prior agreement of the *Supervisor*.

Protection from changes in ground levels

26.06 (1) Without the prior approval of the *Supervisor*, the *Contractor* shall not change the existing ground levels within the tree protection zones of the preserved trees unless the *contract* explicitly requires such changes.

(2) Not used.

(3) Not used.

Protection from instability

26.09 (1) Where the *works* involve cutting of any major roots or other major parts of the preserved trees or any other works that may jeopardise the stability of the preserved trees, the *Contractor* shall install all necessary physical support for the preserved trees to ensure their stability. The *Contractor* shall pay particular attention to the preserved trees growing on retaining structures in order to prevent the trees from being dislodged from its position as a result of inadequate support.

(2) The physical support for the preserved trees shall be installed securely prior to commencement of the root cutting, tree pruning or any other works that may affect the stability of the trees. Before commencing the installation of the physical support measures, the *Contractor* shall submit method statements for the support measures to the *Supervisor* for approval. The *Contractor* shall commence the installation of the support measures only after the *Supervisor*'s approval to the method statements.

(3) The physical support for the preserved trees shall be securely founded in footings independent of existing walls or building structures or in other supporting systems as appropriate, without interfering with other works, other existing features, and the preserved trees. Where the affected tree is growing on a retaining structure, the *Contractor* shall make a detailed assessment to estimate the weight of the tree and identify the best position of supporting the tree in relation to its overall spread and centre of gravity. The method statements for the support measures in respect of the trees growing on retaining structures shall include the following information:

(a) details of the form of construction and where requested by the *Supervisor* structural design calculation for the support measures, demonstrating the bearing capacity of each element,

(b) details of the foundation of the support measures, demonstrating that the support measures shall not interfere with other works, other existing features, and the preserved trees and shall not affect the stability of the retaining structure,

(c) means of securing the tree to the supporting measures, including how cups and ties are adjusted to the form of the tree, and

(d) method of fabrication and erection on the Site.

(4) The *Contractor* shall remove the physical support for the preserved trees from the Site upon completion of *section*, or earlier if so directed by the *Supervisor*. The *Contractor* shall not remove or relocate the physical support for the trees without the prior agreement of the *Supervisor*.

Pruning of preserved trees

26.10 (1) Without the prior approval of the *Supervisor*, the *Contractor* shall not carry out pruning to the preserved trees unless the pruning work is required under the *contract* or is directed by the *Supervisor*. The *Contractor* shall notify the *Supervisor* of any preserved trees whose branches interfere with the *works* and thus require pruning. The *Contractor* shall carry out the approved pruning work during the site clearance stage unless otherwise instructed or agreed by the *Supervisor*.

(2) The *Contractor* shall comply with the following when carrying out the pruning work:

(a) all necessary tools and equipment, and physical support, shall be provided and all necessary safety precautions shall be taken to protect the people engaged in the pruning work as well as the people and property in the vicinity,

(b) all pruning work shall be carried out in accordance with good horticultural practice and the recommendations of BS 3998,

(c) pruning and removal of branches shall be done using sharp, clean implements to give a single flat, sloping face,

(d) ragged, rough edges of bark or wood shall be trimmed cleanly from around wounds with a sharp knife to the minimum extent that is necessary so as to hasten wound closure, and twigs less than 15 mm diameter shall be cut with sharp secateurs,

(e) pruning shall be carried out with the cut just above and sloping away from an outward facing healthy bud, and removal of branch shall be carried out by having the final cut of the last branch segment made just outside the branch collar when it is present or at an angle being the mirror image of the branch bark ridge when there is no branch collar, so that no part of the stem is damaged or torn, and no snags or stumps are left,

(f) large branches shall be removed in stages beginning with the removal of the main weight of the branch from perimeter of crown in towards the trunk and with the final cut of the last branch segment made in a way as described in sub-clause (2)(e) of this Clause, without leaving a stub and damaging the bark,

(g) all cuts shall be made to avoid splintering or tearing of bark that would catch water and encourage rot, and cracks, cavities or rotten wood shall be cut back with a clean, sharp implement to remove the dead, damaged and decayed tissue without damaging the living tissue,

(h) topping, that is cutting off all of the top branches to the same height, shall not be carried out in any circumstances,

(i) unless otherwise instructed by the *Supervisor*, any cuts or wounds shall be left uncovered instead of being painted with wound dressing or coating to avoid water retention and disease development,

(j) any material pruned from the trees shall be removed from the Site as soon as possible, and

(k) any adjacent areas affected by the pruning work shall be reinstated.

(l) For tree pruning works involving the use of chainsaw, the *Contractor* shall assign worker(s) with relevant training to undertake such works. The assigned worker(s) must have passed the *Vocational Assessment in Safety Use and Maintenance of Chainsaw Operation and Basic Tree Pruning for the Arboriculture Industry* organised by the Vocational Training Council ("VTC") or possesses equivalent qualification from a recognized local / overseas training institute or professional body. The *Contractor* shall submit to the *Supervisor* for acceptance of the particulars of the assigned worker(s) (including the name and position) together with a copy of the certificate(s) issued by VTC or other recognized training institute or professional body confirming that the worker(s) has / have obtained the required qualification.

Control of pest and disease for preserved trees

26.11 (1) The *Contractor* shall take all necessary precautionary measures to protect the preserved trees from pest and disease attack and all necessary control measures to eradicate pest and disease from the infected trees.

(2) Before commencing the application of the pest and disease control measures, the *Contractor* shall submit method statements for the control measures to the *Supervisor* for approval. The *Contractor* shall commence the application of the control measures only after obtaining the *Supervisor*'s approval to the method statements.

(3) The method statements for the pest and disease control measures shall cover, amongst other aspects as required by the *Supervisor*, the pesticide or fungicide to be used and any other necessary associated arboricultural work to the infected areas.

(4) The *Contractor* shall comply with the following requirements in applying the pest and disease control measures:

(a) environmentally friendly measures shall be adopted, and

(b) safety precautions as the manufacturer's instruction shall be strictly followed in using pesticide or fungicide so as to avoid causing danger or harm to the public and the environment.

Repair of damage to preserved trees and other affected plants

26.12 (1) The *Contractor* shall carry out all necessary work of repair of any damage to the preserved trees and any other plants affected. All necessary work of repair of damage shall be carried out at the *Contractor*'s own expense if the necessity for such work is, in the opinion of the *Supervisor*, due to neglect or failure on the part of the *Contractor* to comply with any obligation expressed or implied on the *Contractor*'s part under the *contract*.

(2) The work of repair of damage as referred to in sub-clause (1) of this Clause shall include the following:

(a) all necessary arboricultural work to the preserved trees and any other plants damaged, which may include:

(i) tree surgery work to remove dead, damaged, diseased or hazardous parts, to repair wounds, or to provide cables or braces for additional support,

(ii) watering and/or mulching in case of water deficiency, and

(iii) applying appropriate fertilizers in case of nutrient deficiency,

(b) the replacement planting pursuant to sub-clause (7) of this Clause for the trees and any other plants damaged to an extent as described in sub-clause (6) of this Clause and the subsequent Establishment Works for the new plants for 1 year, when instructed by the *Supervisor*, and

(c) any other reinstatement work necessary to bring the damaged plants to their original condition prior to the occurrence of the damage, as directed by the *Supervisor*.

(3) The *Contractor* shall notify the *Supervisor* of any damage to the preserved trees and other affected plants within the same day of the occurrence of damage and shall submit to the *Supervisor* within 7 days of the occurrence of damage, a report comprising the following information in a format agreed by *Supervisor*:

(a) the timing of the damage,

(b) the nature and extent of the damage,

(c) photographic records of the damage,

(d) the proposed work of repair of the damage, and

(e) the proposed protection measures to avoid recurrence of similar incident.

(4) When directed by the *Supervisor*, the *Contractor* shall firm up and secure all dislodged trees and any other dislodged plants and shall treat all wounds of the damaged trees/plants within 3 days of the occurrence of the damage.

(5) Save as stated in sub-clause (4) of this Clause, the *Contractor* shall not carry out any work of repair of the damage prior to the *Supervisor*'s acceptance of the report as required in sub-clause (3) of this Clause.

(6) The *Contractor* shall provide replacement planting of the damaged trees and any other affected plants under the following circumstances:

(a) in the opinion of the *Supervisor* the damaged trees/plants are dead,

(b) in the opinion of the *Supervisor*, the trees/plants have been substantially damaged, resulting in one or more of the following conditions:

(i) that imminent death of the trees/plants within the coming growing season is predicted,

(ii) that the structural integrity of the damaged trees/plants is permanently compromised and consequently the trees/plants become an irreparable public hazard,

(iii) that any major parts of the damaged trees/plants have been lost and consequently their form, habit and balance have been grossly altered so that their function cannot be reasonably recovered or the trees/plants are causing harm to other preserved trees.

(7) When instructed by the *Supervisor*, the *Contractor* shall carry out the following:

(a) removal of the damaged trees/plants for which replacement planting as sub-clause (6) of this Clause is required, in accordance with the following requirements:

(i) for the removal of the damaged trees, the *Contractor* shall prepare a tree felling application document to the *Supervisor*'s

satisfaction and provide any other assistance or information as required by the *Supervisor*, for the *Supervisor*'s application for approval to the felling of the damaged trees from the government approving authority,

(ii) the *Contractor* shall fell the damaged trees only after the *Supervisor*'s approval to the tree felling, which shall normally be given only after the tree felling application has been approved by the government approving authority, and

(iii) the *Contractor* shall remove the damaged plants from the Site, and

(b) replacement planting of new plants in accordance with the following requirements:

(i) the *Contractor* shall complete the replacement planting within 28 days from the *Supervisor*'s instruction or other time duration as agreed by the *Supervisor*, and

(ii) for replacement planting, the *Contractor* shall plant new plants of the same species and of similar size and form as the damaged plants prior to the damage or provide other alternative replacement planting as agreed by the *Supervisor*.

Other references 26.13 (1) The *Contractor*'s attention is also drawn to the latest editions of the following British Standards and British Standard Code of Practice for general reference:

BS 3998	Recommendations for tree work
BS 4043	Recommendations for transplanting root-balled trees
BS 4428	Code of practice for general landscape operations (excluding hard surfaces)
BS 5837	Guide for tree in relation to construction
DEVB (GLTM) 200/2/1/1	Technical Circular (Works) No. 4/2020) – Tree Preservation
GEO Publication No. 1/2011	Technical Guidelines on Landscape Treatment for Slopes
DEVB (GLTM) (Sept	Guidelines on Tree Transplanting

2014)

(2) The provisions contained in this Particular Specification and the Drawings shall prevail over the provisions contained in the documents listed in the sub-clause (1) of this Clause.

(3) The *Contractor* should also draw attention to the requirements stipulated under the specifications for procurement of arboricultural services under the Cyber Manual for Greening, in particular, but not limited to, sub-section Tree Planting and Management.

Tree pruning works involving the use of chainsaw

26.14 For tree pruning works involving the use of chainsaw, the *Contractor* shall assign worker(s) with relevant training to undertake such works. The assigned worker(s) must have passed the *Vocational Assessment in Safety Use and Maintenance of Chainsaw Operation and Basic Tree Pruning for the Arboriculture Industry* organized by the Vocational Training Council ("VTC") or possesses equivalent qualification from a recognized local/overseas training institute or professional body. The *Contractor* shall submit to the *Supervisor* for approval of the particulars of the assigned worker(s) (including the name and position) together with a copy of the certificate(s) issued by VTC or other recognized training institute or professional body confirming that the worker(s) has/have obtained the required qualification.

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